

if you are unable to quantify which source is working out well for you, how do you know where to focus your energies?

When you use a basic GA setup, you will be able to track the performance of the preset default channel groupings:

- Direct – users who visit the website without coming through a specified source.
- Referral – users who come to your website via another website.
- Organic – users who visit the website via a search engine.
- Paid search – users who visit via paid search advertising.
- Social – users who have been brought to your site via social media platforms.

By default, GA is not going to identify the different marketing campaigns that send visitors to your site. If you want GA to show you relevant data for this, you will need to set up campaigns and indulge in a little campaign tagging.

What Is Campaign Tagging?

In simple words, campaign tagging is a process that allows one to add tags to their website links which get used in marketing campaigns. These tags are capable of passing information on to GA about the link that was clicked. This means that you have the power to determine which of your marketing campaigns are doing well and thus focus your energies on your marketing strategies accordingly.

The Basics

When you have clicked on the link of an ad you saw online and it takes you to a new tab, have you paid attention to the hyperlink? Have you ever noticed that in these cases, hyperlinks are usually one mile long and have the term ‘utm’ appear repeatedly.

UTM stands for Urchin Tracking Module. It is the system that allows users to tag hyperlinks so that they can track the origins of the visitor’s journey up until their website. GA users can use UTM to figure out how people end up on their site and what they are doing once they get there. You also have the option of adding additional text to the ends of the hyperlinks that you are sharing and this will tag users of the link, as well as hit your site with information about the following queries:

- Where did these users come from.
- What did they click on or interact with while on your site.